

Robert S. Ricks Jr.

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EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATION

Virginia Tech , Blacksburg, VA — Ph.D. in Accounting and Information Systems	2024 – May 2029 (Expected)
Auburn University , Auburn, AL — Master of Accountancy (MAcc)	2018 – 2019
Auburn University , Auburn, AL — B.S. in Business Administration, Accountancy (Summa Cum Laude)	2015 – 2017
Certified Public Accountant, State of Alabama	Active

ACADEMIC AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Virginia Tech , Blacksburg, VA — Graduate Research Assistant and Teaching Instructor	2024 – Present
BBB Industries, LLC , Daphne, AL — Tax Senior Analyst	2023 – 2024
Warren Averett, LLC , Foley, AL — Tax Senior	2020 – 2023
Deloitte, LLP , Atlanta, GA — Tax Consultant, Business Tax Services, Real Estate	2019 – 2020
Auburn University , Auburn, AL — Graduate Teaching Assistant	2018 – 2019

RESEARCH

Interests: Financial Reporting, Human Capital · **Methods:** Archival, Survey

Works in Progress

“Accounting Student Decisions Following the Alternative CPA Licensure Pathway: Survey Evidence on Master’s Programs and CPA Exam Intentions.” Advisor: Robert Davidson.

Surveys accounting undergraduate and graduate students and master’s program directors to examine planned enrollment and CPA exam taking following the lowering of CPA licensure education requirements in the alternative pathway. Status: draft in progress. Presentation: Second Year Paper Presentation, Virginia Tech PhD Program (2026, planned).

“Are state tax agency employees impacted by federal enforcement staffing changes?” With Andrew Acito, Michelle Nessa, and Logan Natvig.

Examines the relationship between cuts to federal tax employees located in a state and subsequent employment at that state’s tax agency. Status: data collection in progress.

CONFERENCE PARTICIPATION

A = Attendee · D = Discussant · R = Reviewer · P = Presenter

Virginia Tech Accounting Research Conference A	2026
Virginia Accounting Research Conference (VARC) A	2026
Financial Accounting and Reporting Section (FARS) Midyear Meeting A, R	2026
International Accounting Section (IAS) Midyear Meeting R	2026
Virginia Accounting Research Conference (VARC) A	2025
Virginia Tech Accounting Research Conference A	2024

TEACHING — VIRGINIA TECH

ACIS 2116: Intro to Managerial Accounting — two sections (rating: 4.99/6)	2025
ACIS 3314: Tax Impact on Decisions — led quiz review class for three sections	2026

SCHOLARSHIPS AND AWARDS

Accounting and Information Systems Alumni Scholarship	2026
Ronald J. Patten Scholarship in Accounting and Information Systems	2026
AICPA Foundation Fellowship for Accounting Doctoral Students	2026
Thomas M. Berry Scholarship, Virginia Society of Certified Public Accountants (VSCPA)	2026
Thomas M. Wells and Kathy Dargo Accounting and Information Systems Fellowship	2024, 2025

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

AAA weARE Webinar: How to Communicate Academic Research to a Broad Audience	2026
AI's Impact on the Future of Graduate Education & Research Workshop (VT)	2026
Pamplin AI Teaching Workshop (VT)	2026
AAA weARE Webinar: Using Collaborative Learning Techniques to Teach Ethics to Accounting Students	2025
AAA weARE Webinar: Integrating Ethics into the Accounting Curriculum	2025

REVIEWS

Web of Science Researcher ID: PJT-7784-2026 · Verified peer reviews: Asian Review of Accounting (2)